T20 CRICKET WORLD CUP

THE STARS TO BEAT

By **SAIKAT NIYOGI**

T20 CRICKET CAME AS A PERFECT FITMENT FOR OUR TIMES—with all the shrinking attention spans and the ever-increasing bloodlust for big hoicks more often. By the time the first ICC T20 World Cup was held in 2007, the belligerents were match-ready. It was a dream start for India, who lifted the inaugural Cup under M.S. Dhoni's inspiring leadership. In subsequent years, India was runner-up in 2014, and won it again in 2024. With 20 teams playing 55 matches, this 10th edition is also the biggest Cup yet. A cloud hung over the tournament for a brief while—Bangladesh, Pakistan and India being the principal protagonists of the drama—before ICC mediation restored a modicum of peace. Balls are being thwacked to the cow corners, and big names are falling to the guiles of steadfast spinners even as we speak. Cricket's uncertainties are deliciously tart; still, we dare to hope for glory. Here's a heady sprinkle of great deeds from the past Cups:



PTI

THE DOMINATOR

Virat Kohli | 2012-24 |

He is still the man to beat in the batting records department. Has the most runs: **1,292** (35 matches); most 50s: **15**; most runs in a tournament: **319** (2014 edition); and was also Player of the Tournament twice, in 2014 and 2016

KEEPING SCORE

BEST BOWLING FIGURES
Ajantha Mendis: 6 wickets for 8 runs vs Zimbabwe (2012)

MOST CATCHES
David Warner
25 catches in 41 matches

BEST STRIKE RATE
Jos Buttler
147.42 in 36 innings

HIGHEST / LOWEST TOTALS
Sri Lanka: (260/6) vs Kenya (2007)
Uganda: (39) vs West Indies (2024)

HIGHEST INDIVIDUAL SCORE
Brendan McCullum
123 vs Bangladesh (2012); SR: 212

MOST DISMISSALS BY A WK
32 by **Quinton De Kock** (28 matches) and **M.S. Dhoni** (33 matches)



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